



You can *count* on PEOPLE

HANDS AND FEET

The tribes of Papua New Guinea have at least 900 different counting systems. Many tribes count past their fingers and so don't use base ten. One tribe counts toes after fingers, giving them a base 20 system. Their word for 10 is *two hands*. Fifteen is *two hands and one foot*, and 20 is *one man*.



Head and shoulders

In some parts of Papua New Guinea, tribal people start counting on a little finger and then cross the hand, arm, and body before running down the other arm. The Faiwol tribe count 27 body parts and use the words for body parts as numbers. The word for 14 is *nose*, for instance. For numbers bigger than 27, they add *one man*. So 40 would be *one man and right eye*.

